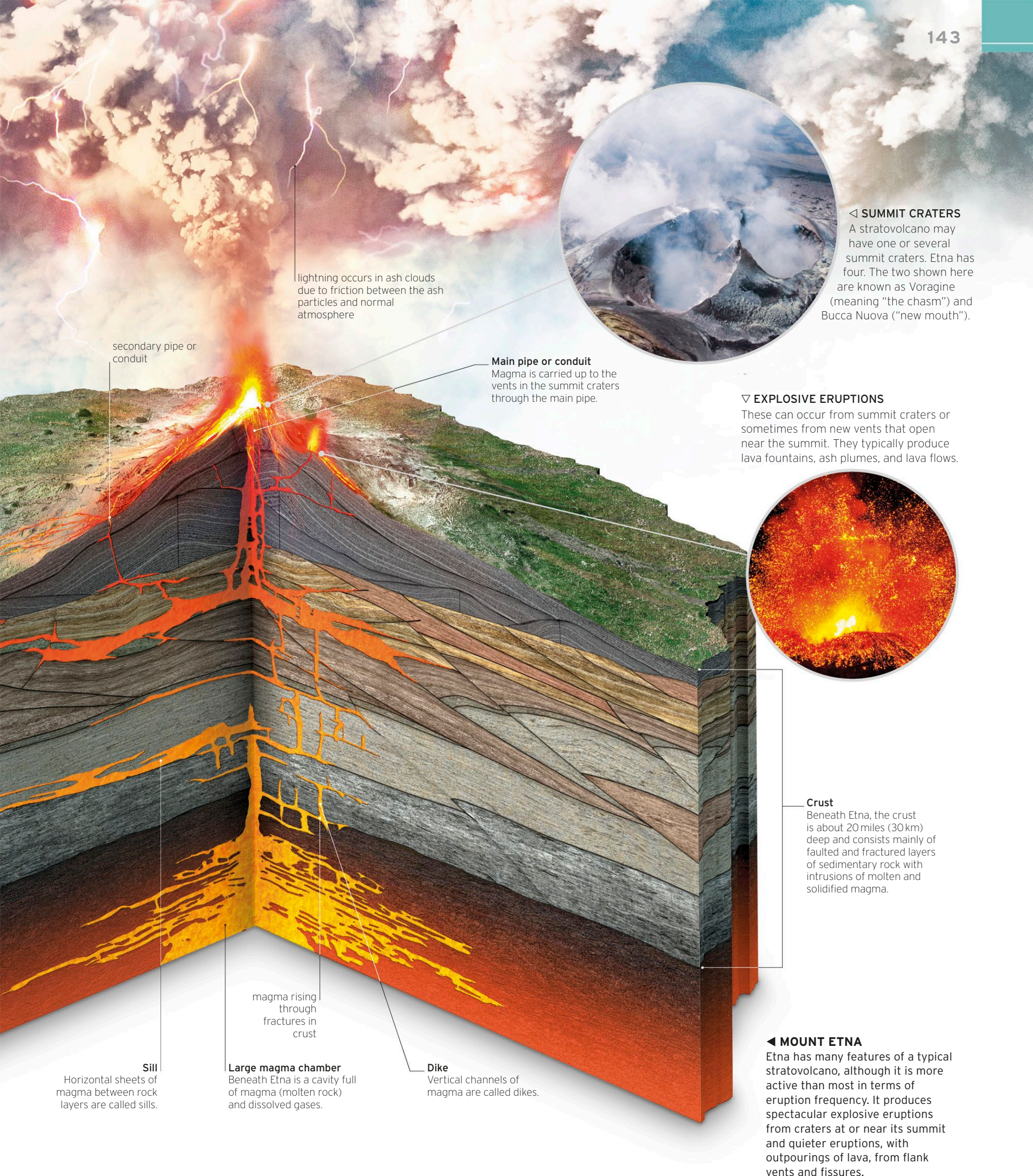




lightning occurs in ash clouds due to friction between the ash particles and normal atmosphere

secondary pipe or conduit

Main pipe or conduit

Magma is carried up to the vents in the summit craters through the main pipe.

◁ SUMMIT CRATERS

A stratovolcano may have one or several summit craters. Etna has four. The two shown here are known as Voragine (meaning "the chasm") and Bucca Nuova ("new mouth").

▽ EXPLOSIVE ERUPTIONS

These can occur from summit craters or sometimes from new vents that open near the summit. They typically produce lava fountains, ash plumes, and lava flows.

Crust

Beneath Etna, the crust is about 20 miles (30 km) deep and consists mainly of faulted and fractured layers of sedimentary rock with intrusions of molten and solidified magma.

Sill

Horizontal sheets of magma between rock layers are called sills.

Large magma chamber

Beneath Etna is a cavity full of magma (molten rock) and dissolved gases.

Dike

Vertical channels of magma are called dikes.

◀ MOUNT ETNA

Etna has many features of a typical stratovolcano, although it is more active than most in terms of eruption frequency. It produces spectacular explosive eruptions from craters at or near its summit and quieter eruptions, with outpourings of lava, from flank vents and fissures.